Dialogue Bible

Status: working draft. Items marked **[proposal]** are not decided yet.

1. Language

- All dialogue lines, choices and narration are written in **English**.
- German stays in internal notes only (this wiki, the Regelwerk, the Portrait-Bibel).

2. Speaker tags

Every line starts with the speaker's display name, including the title:

- Sheriff Bulut
- Bartender Ilhan
- Doctor Veronica
- Madame Elenora
- Narrator (no name shown, narration style)

Monsters never appear as a named speaker. Their grin is an expression, nothing more.

Name colors

Speaker	Name color	Status
Sheriff Bulut	offen	**[proposal]** pick one that is not used by anyone else
Bartender Ilhan	offen	**[proposal]** pick one that is not used by anyone else
Doctor Veronica	Stroh und Sand #b89a72	festgelegt
Madame Elenora	Stoff Rot gedämpft #7a2e3a	festgelegt, Lesbarkeit prüfen
Narrator	Zeichenfarbe #9ab87a, ohne Name	festgelegt

3. Expression tags

Each line carries at most one expression tag. The tags are English in code and map to the Portrait-Bibel frames.

Tag	Portrait-Bibel	Used by
calm	Ruhig	everyone
tense	Angespannt	Bulut
cold	Kalt	Bulut, Ilhan, Elenora
suspicious	Misstrauisch	everyone
angry	Wütend	Ilhan, Elenora
scared	Verängstigt	everyone
sympathetic	Mitfühlend	Veronica
sad	Traurig	Veronica
determined	Entschlossen	Veronica
fake_smile	Falsch lächelnd (ohne Zähne)	Elenora
grin	Grinsen	Monsters only

Portrait coverage

The Portrait-Bibel asks for at least four expressions per figure.

- Bulut: calm, tense, cold, suspicious. Complete
- Ilhan: calm, cold, angry. **Missing one**
- Veronica: calm, sympathetic, sad, determined. Complete
- Elenora: calm, cold, fake_smile. **Missing one**

4. Voice per speaker

- **Bulut:** short sentences, pauses. He pleads and does not command. He is calm on the outside and tense underneath.
- **Ilhan:** few words. Cold until the player contradicts him. He never raises his voice before that.
- **Veronica:** warm and calm. Uses medical terms naturally, without lecturing.
- **Elenora:** polite and icy. She never shouts. Every sentence sounds like a contract.

- **Narrator:** present tense, third person. Describes what the player sees and hears. No thoughts of characters, no judgements.

5. Line rules

- One speaker per line.
- Stage directions never go into speaker lines. Use a Narrator line.
- **[proposal]** Maximum 25 words per line. Longer text is split.
- Pauses are timing data in the dialogue system, not written text. Bulut's lines have a 1 to 2 second pause before them.
- A scene never shows a monster and a human together, in any state.

6. Choices

- 2 to 4 options per choice point.
- **[proposal]** Labels are at most six words, written from the player's view, in the imperative: „Go with him."
- The effect is in the file, not in the label.
- Every relationship change uses the clamp: `~ rel_x = MAX(-10, MIN(10, rel_x + n))`.

7. Relationships

- Range: −10 to +10, directed (from → to).
- Bands: **hostile** −10 to −5 (red #d64a6a), **neutral** −4 to +4 (grey #6e6a74), **trusted** +5 to +10 (green #9ab87a).
- **[proposal]** Variable names follow `rel_<from>_<to>`. Decide before writing Ink: keep the German IDs from the sheet (spieler, dorf, villa) or switch to English (player, village, manor).

8. Glossary

- **Loop:** the day restarts after the player dies outside at night.
- **Talisman:** protects one shelter. Every shelter needs exactly one.
- **Shelter:** a house, the Revier, the Bar, the Praxis, the Villa room.
- **Revier:** the village police station, the Sheriff's place. Has a talisman.
- **Wake level (Wecklevel):** 0 to 5. **[proposal]** The „danger level" in our notes is the same thing.

9. Example: Scene 3 in English (draft)

> **Sheriff Bulut** [tense]: Listen to me. Please. Don't panic.
>
> **Sheriff Bulut** [cold]: What happened to you happened to all of us. Nobody who arrived here understood it right away.
>
> **Sheriff Bulut** [tense]: We'll get through this together. But not out here. You have to come with me to the Revier. I can explain everything there.
>
> **Sheriff Bulut** [suspicious]: Please. Trust me.
>
> **Choice**
>
> - „Go with him." → `rel_bulut_spieler +1`, → Revier
> - „Drive on." → cutscene, → loop

10. Open decisions

1. Name colors for Bulut and Ilhan.
2. Keep the German IDs or switch to English in code.
3. Maximum line length: 25 words?
4. May villagers name the monsters, or do they only say „they"? (they can say both)
5. Is the danger level the same as the wake level?
6. Missing expressions for Ilhan and Elenora.